

LIGHT MACHINE-GUNS (1945–65)

The development of light machine-guns in the years following World War II drew heavily on designs that had been created during the war, particularly in Germany. This is most evident in the US M60 and the Mauser-CETME arms, which parallel the wartime German MG42 (see p.193), StG44 (see p.177), and StG45. These light machine-guns also began to use sheet metal stampings and light-weight metal alloys extensively in their construction.

► FN MAG

Date	1958
Origin	Belgium
Barrel	21½in (55cm)
Caliber	7.62 × 51mm NATO

The MAG (*Mitrailleuse à Gaz*, meaning gas-operated machine-gun), produced by FN, used a modified form of the locking system developed by John Browning for his Automatic Rifle (see p.194); this was married to the feed mechanism of the MG42. This gun could fire 650–1,000 rounds per minute and was adopted by the British Army as their General-Purpose Machine-Gun (GPMG).



▲ DEGTYAREV RP46

Date	1946
Origin	Soviet Union
Barrel	23¾in (60.5cm)
Caliber	7.62 × 54mm

The Red Army adopted the Degtyarev DP in 1928. It was modified in 1945, and the following year, it received a heavier barrel and was adapted to take belts as well as drum magazines, evolving into the RP46. It was still not entirely satisfactory, however, and was soon replaced by the RPD.

